

Grenada



Area 131 sq miles
(340 sq km)
Population 109,000
Capital St. George's
Currency East Caribbean dollar
Official language English
Life expectancy 68 years



Grenada is a group of islands north of Trinidad and Tobago. A former British colony, Grenada became independent in 1974. It was the world's second-largest producer of nutmeg until Hurricane Ivan devastated crops in 2004.

Antigua and Barbuda



Area 171 sq miles
(442 sq km)
Population 89,000
Capital St. John's
Currency East Caribbean dollar
Official language English
Life expectancy 75 years



Antigua and Barbuda lies between the Caribbean Sea and the Atlantic Ocean. In addition to the two major islands, Antigua and Barbuda, there are also several smaller islands, some of which are uninhabited.

Trinidad and Tobago



Area 1,980 sq miles
(5,128 sq km)
Population 1.3 million
Capital Port-of-Spain
Currency Trinidad and Tobago dollar
Official language English
Life expectancy 70 years



The islands of Trinidad and Tobago are located just 9 miles (15 km) from the South American mainland. The mountains and swamps of the islands are rich in tropical flora and fauna. Trinidad has the largest south Asian community in the Caribbean.



▲ SCARLET IBIS

The national bird of Trinidad, the scarlet ibis, is native to the Caribbean islands and parts of South America.

The country was colonized by the British in 1632, and gained its independence in 1981. British cultural influence remains strong, and Antiguan have a passion for the popular British sport of cricket. Most of the population of Antigua and Barbuda is descended from the Africans brought to the islands between the 16th and 19th centuries to work as slaves. There are also small European and south Asian communities. In recent years, many Spanish-speaking immigrants from the Dominican Republic have moved to Antigua and Barbuda.

Luxury tourism is a major industry here. However, sewage from tourist hotels has caused serious environmental problems: Uncontrolled and untreated waste from the hotels pollute the sea, killing valuable fish stocks in the large mangrove swamps.

▼ VACATION DESTINATION

Antigua has 365 beaches. The clear Caribbean waters off these sandy beaches are ideal for snorkeling and attract many vacationers.

